```
User.where(id: 1).joins(:articles).explain
```

may yield

```
EXPLAIN for: SELECT `users`.* FROM `users` INNER JOIN `articles` ON
`articles`.`user_id` = `users`.`id` WHERE `users`.`id` = 1
+----+-------------+----------+-------+---------------+
| id | select_type | table    | type  | possible_keys |
+----+-------------+----------+-------+---------------+
|  1 | SIMPLE      | users    | const | PRIMARY       |
|  1 | SIMPLE      | articles | ALL   | NULL          |
+----+-------------+----------+-------+---------------+
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------------+
| key     | key_len | ref   | rows | Extra       |
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------------+
| PRIMARY | 4       | const |    1 |             |
| NULL    | NULL    | NULL  |    1 | Using where |
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------------+

2 rows in set (0.00 sec)
```

under MySQL.

Active Record performs a pretty printing that emulates the one of the database shells. So, the same query running with the PostgreSQL adapter would yield instead

```
EXPLAIN for: SELECT "users".* FROM "users" INNER JOIN "articles" ON
"articles"."user_id" = "users"."id" WHERE "users"."id" = 1
                                  QUERY PLAN
------------------------------------------------------------------------------
--------
 Nested Loop Left Join  (cost=0.00..37.24 rows=8 width=0)
   Join Filter: (articles.user_id = users.id)
   ->  Index Scan using users_pkey on users  (cost=0.00..8.27 rows=1
width=4)
         Index Cond: (id = 1)
   ->  Seq Scan on articles  (cost=0.00..28.88 rows=8 width=4)
         Filter: (articles.user_id = 1)
(6 rows)
```

Eager loading may trigger more than one query under the hood, and some queries may need the results of previous ones. Because of that, `explain` actually executes the query, and then asks for the query plans.

For example,

```
User.where(id: 1).includes(:articles).explain
```

yields

```
EXPLAIN for: SELECT `users`.* FROM `users`  WHERE `users`.`id` = 1
+----+-------------+-------+-------+---------------+
| id | select_type | table | type  | possible_keys |
+----+-------------+-------+-------+---------------+
|  1 | SIMPLE      | users | const | PRIMARY       |
+----+-------------+-------+-------+---------------+
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------+
| key     | key_len | ref   | rows | Extra |
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------+
| PRIMARY | 4       | const |    1 |       |
+---------+---------+-------+------+-------+

1 row in set (0.00 sec)

EXPLAIN for: SELECT `articles`.* FROM `articles`  WHERE
`articles`.`user_id` IN (1)
+----+-------------+----------+------+---------------+
| id | select_type | table    | type | possible_keys |
```